PioDeploy

User Guide & Getting-Started Manual

Software deployment & policy management for Windows fleets

Covers: requesting access · subscribing · signing in · setting up clients & projects · installing the agent · deploying software · browser policies · viewing compliance · administration

Version 1.0 · TechPio · https://piodeploy.com

Contents

1. Introduction

PioDeploy is a centralised software-deployment and policy-management platform for Windows fleets, built for MSPs and IT teams. From one web portal you can install, update, patch, pin, and remove software, and lock down browser settings, across every managed machine — silently, with real-time compliance.

How it works, in one picture

The portal	A website (e.g. `https://piodeploy.com`) where you define what your machines should look like — packages, policies, browser rules — and see compliance.
The agent	A tiny Windows service installed once per machine. It runs as **SYSTEM**, checks in over HTTPS, and carries out deployments **silently** — the end user sees nothing.
Desired state	You set a rule once ("Chrome always latest", "remove AnyDesk"). Machines that drift are corrected automatically.

> **Key idea:** you never touch machines one by one. You describe the desired state in the portal; the agents make it so and keep it that way — invisibly, without interrupting anyone's work.

2. Getting started

2.1 Requesting access

PioDeploy is a back-office tool, so there is **no public self-registration** — accounts are provisioned for you. To get started:

1. Go to `https://piodeploy.com` and click **Get started** (or **Request access**).
2. Fill in the form — name, work email, company, and approximate number of machines — and submit.
3. The PioDeploy team receives your request and sets up your tenant and first admin login, then emails you the details.

> **Note:** if you run your own PioDeploy instance, your administrator creates accounts from **Users → Add user** instead. Either way, you receive a login email and password.

2.2 Choosing a plan & subscribing (buying)

Pricing is **per machine under management**, billed monthly, on a graduated schedule that gets cheaper at scale:

MACHINES	PRICE EACH / MONTH
First 20	$0.80
Next 480 (21–500)	$0.40
500 and above	$0.20

To subscribe:

1. Open the **Pricing** page on the website.
2. Drag the **slider** (or type a number) to your machine count — the monthly total and per-machine average update live. Example: 250 machines = **$108/month**.
3. Click **Subscribe**. You are taken to a secure **Stripe** checkout page.
4. Enter your card details and confirm. Stripe supports 135+ currencies for international cards.
5. You land on a confirmation page; a receipt is emailed to you and your subscription appears under **Admin → Billing**.

> **Test cards:** if the instance is in Stripe test mode, use card `4242 4242 4242 4242`, any future expiry and any CVC. No real money is charged.

Enterprise / unlimited / custom volumes: use the **Contact** page to reach sales for a tailored quote.

2.3 Signing in

1. Go to `https://piodeploy.com/login`.
2. Enter the email and password from your welcome email.
3. (Recommended) enable **two-factor authentication** from your profile menu for extra security.

> **Forgot your password?** Click "Forgot your password?" on the login page to receive a reset link by email.

3. The portal at a glance

The left sidebar is your map. What you see depends on your role.

SECTION	WHAT IT'S FOR
Dashboard	Fleet health at a glance — online/offline, pending & failed deployments, compliance.
Clients	Your customer organisations (each customer is a client).
Projects	A group of machines under a client. Agents enrol into a project.
Computers	Every enrolled machine, its hardware/software inventory and health.
Packages	The approved software catalogue (winget / Chocolatey / MSI / EXE ...).
Deployments	The live queue and history of install/update/remove jobs.
Policies	Desired-state software rules (install / update / pin / remove).
Browser Policies	Lock down incognito, guest mode, password saving, dev tools.
Reports	Compliance, deployment activity and fleet health — with CSV export.
Users / Roles	Team accounts and what each role may do.
Notifications	Email/webhook alerts on failures, offline agents, drift.
Website / Billing / Settings	Edit the marketing site, manage payments, tune platform defaults.

4. Setting up your fleet

Structure is **Client** → **Project** → **Machines**. Do this once before enrolling machines.

4.1 Create a client

1. Sidebar → **Clients** → **New client**.
2. Enter the company name (e.g. *Acme Corporation*) and status **Active**. Save.

4.2 Create a project

1. Sidebar → **Projects** → **New project**.
2. Pick the client, name it (e.g. *Acme HQ Laptops*), save.
3. On creation you are shown two things **once**:

Agent API key	`pio_xxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxxx` — machines use this to authenticate. Copy and store it safely.
Agent download URL	`https://piodeploy.com/download/agent/<token>` — the installer script for this project.

> **Lost the API key?** Open the project and click **Rotate key** to generate a new one (the old one stops working). The download URL is always visible on the project's edit page.

4.3 The software catalogue

Packages lists the software you can deploy — pre-seeded with ~120 popular titles (Chrome, 7-Zip, Firefox, VLC, Notepad++, ...), each with its winget/Chocolatey id. To add your own, click **New Package** and provide the name, type (winget / choco / MSI / EXE / MSIX / ZIP) and identifier or installer URL.

5. Installing the agent

5.1 What the agent is

The agent is a small **.NET Windows service** that runs as **LocalSystem**. It registers the machine, sends hardware/software inventory, and carries out deployments — all **silently in the background**. Nothing appears on the user's screen; no prompts, no windows, no interruption.

5.2 Test install on one machine

Good for verifying before a fleet rollout. On the target Windows PC, open **PowerShell as Administrator** and run (using your project's real download URL and API key):

```
# download the installer for this project
irm "https://piodeploy.com/download/agent/<token>" -OutFile install-agent.ps1

# install + start the service
.\install-agent.ps1 -ApiKey "pio_your-project-key"
```

Within a minute the machine appears under **Computers**, online.

5.3 Zero-touch rollout across the fleet

You do **not** install machine-by-machine at scale. Push the agent once through the tooling you already run — it executes as SYSTEM with no user interaction. The whole install is a single command:

```
powershell -ExecutionPolicy Bypass -Command "iwr 'https://piodeploy.com/download/agent/<token>' -OutFile $env:TEMP\pio.ps1 -UseBasicParsing; & $env:TEMP\pio.ps1 -ApiKey '<KEY>'"
```

METHOD	WHERE IT GOES
Group Policy (domain)	Computer Configuration → Startup script. Runs as SYSTEM at boot.
Microsoft Intune (cloud)	Devices → Platform scripts. Set "run using logged-on credentials: No".
Your RMM	A single "run script" job across a device group.

> **Result:** every targeted machine enrols silently in the background, and from then on all deployments are invisible to users. This is how you reach thousands of endpoints with zero interruption.

6. Deploying software (policies)

A **policy** is a desired-state rule applied to every machine in a project. The agent enforces it automatically on check-in and heals any drift.

Create a software policy

1. Sidebar → **Policies** → **New policy**.
2. Choose the **project** and **package** (e.g. Google Chrome).
3. Pick the **rule**:

RULE	MEANING
Install	Put it on machines that don't have it.
Auto update	Keep it current on machines that have it.
Force update	Reinstall the desired version even if current.
Remove	Uninstall wherever it's found.
Block	Forbidden software — removed whenever detected.

4. Optionally set a **version** (Latest / Exact e.g. `24.09` / Minimum / Freeze), **priority**, **maintenance window** (e.g. Sat 02:00–05:00), **frequency**, and **deployment rings** (Pilot first, Production after N days).
5. Choose the **mode**: **Enforce** (queues jobs) or **Audit only** (reports compliance, changes nothing). Save.

> **Tip:** open a policy to see its compliance drill-down — every machine's status (Protected / Pending / Failed / Scheduled) with reasons, plus per-machine **Exclude** for exceptions like a CEO laptop.

One-off deploy to a single machine

Open **Computers** → **a machine**, use **Quick deploy** to queue an install/update/remove immediately without a policy.

7. Browser policies

Lock down browsers like enterprise Group Policy — without a domain. Supported: Chrome, Edge, Firefox, Brave (Opera reports "unsupported").

1. Sidebar → **Browser Policies** → **New policy**.
2. Name it, pick the project, and choose the restriction:

- **Disable incognito / private browsing**
- **Disable guest mode**
- **Disable password saving**
- **Disable developer tools**

3. Choose browsers (or **All**) and set **Active**. Save.

The agent applies the corresponding registry values (Chrome/Edge/Brave) or `policies.json` (Firefox) silently. Browsers already open show "pending restart" until reopened. Deleting the policy rolls the setting back automatically.

> **Example:** "Block incognito — all browsers" on *Acme HQ Laptops* disables private browsing across every Chromium browser and Firefox on every machine in that project.

8. Viewing your fleet

Dashboard

Online vs offline machines, pending & failed deployments, software counts, and a browser-policy compliance widget.

Computers

Click any machine to see hardware, installed software, health checks (disk, secure boot, last check-in), its deployment history and browser-policy status.

Deployments

The live job queue and history — filter by status/action, retry failed jobs, cancel pending ones.

Reports (with CSV export)

REPORT	SHOWS
Policy compliance	Every policy's % compliant with drill-down.
Deployment activity	Jobs over a date range, success rate, failures.
Fleet health	Every machine: ring, agent state, last seen, disk pressure.

Each report has an **Export CSV** button (for users with the export permission).

9. Notifications

Get alerted when things need attention. Sidebar → **Notifications** → **Add channel**.

CHANNEL	USE
Email	Any address, via the configured mail server.
Webhook	Posts JSON with a Slack/Discord-compatible message — paste a Slack incoming-webhook URL as-is.

Subscribe each channel to events: **deployment failed**, **new computer enrolled**, **agent offline**, **daily compliance drift digest**, **browser policy failed**. Use **Send test** to verify.

10. Administration

Users & roles

Users → **Add user** creates a team account with a role. Roles (Super Admin, Admin, Manager, Technician, Client, Viewer) are permission sets you can edit on the **Roles** matrix — tick a box to grant a permission to a role. **Client** users are scoped to their own client's data only.

Settings

Company name, agent online threshold, offline-alert delay, default job retries, policy backoff, and activity-log retention — all editable, no redeploy.

Website content & Billing

Website edits the public marketing copy (hero, pricing intro, contact). **Billing** shows your Stripe connection status, currency, and recent payments.

Impersonation ("Login as")

A Super Admin can click the → on a user row to log in as them (in a new tab) for support — every start/stop is audit-logged, and a banner shows you're impersonating. Click **Return to my account** to exit.

11. Integration API

Automate PioDeploy from your own tools. Create a token from your **profile menu → API Tokens**, choosing abilities **read** and/or **deploy**.

```
# list computers
curl -H "Authorization: Bearer <token>" https://piodeploy.com/api/v1/computers

# queue a deployment
curl -X POST https://piodeploy.com/api/v1/deployments \
  -H "Authorization: Bearer <token>" \
  -d computer_id=12 -d package_id=7 -d action=install
```

Endpoints cover clients, projects, computers, packages, deployments and policies (read), and queuing deployments (deploy). Everything respects your role permissions and data scope.

12. Troubleshooting & FAQ

SYMPTOM	CAUSE / FIX
Machine doesn't appear under Computers	Agent not installed or wrong API key. Re-run the installer as Administrator with the correct `-ApiKey`.
Deployment failed: "Win32Exception … start process"	Agent couldn't find winget as SYSTEM. Ensure the agent is v1.2.0+ (re-run the installer to upgrade), then retry the job.
Install script warns "no agent bundle published"	The server hasn't got the agent bundle. Your administrator publishes it once; then re-download the script.
Browser policy shows "pending restart"	The browser was open when the policy applied — it takes effect on next browser restart.
Client user sees "account isn't linked to a client"	The Client-role account has no client binding. Admin: Users → set its Client binding, or change the role.

Is it really silent?

Yes. The agent runs as a SYSTEM service in session 0; every installer runs quietly (winget `--silent`, MSI `/qn`, etc.) with no window. Users are never interrupted.

Do I need a domain?

No. The agent works on standalone and domain-joined machines alike. Push it via GPO, Intune, your RMM, or install manually.

Getting help

Use the **Contact** page on the website, or email your PioDeploy administrator. Include the machine hostname and the deployment job id when reporting a failure.

> **You're all set.** Define desired state once, push the agent silently, and let PioDeploy keep your fleet compliant — invisibly.